

Newsletter

Dear Parents, Guardians and Staff,



As we move further into the academic term and the Mid-Year Examination period progresses, I would like to take a moment to reflect on the incredible commitment, resilience, and spirit that continue to define our Curro Clayville community.

Over the past few weeks, our learners have not only focused on academic preparation but have also continued to excel beyond the classroom through sport, leadership, creative expression, and academic enrichment opportunities. Whether participating in Olympiads, representing the school on the sports field, or submitting remarkable pieces for Curro Create, our learners continue to demonstrate courage, talent, and a willingness to challenge themselves in meaningful ways.

This edition of the newsletter highlights an important reminder that success is not built on academics alone. Balance, wellbeing, discipline, creativity, and resilience all play a vital role in shaping confident and capable young individuals. We remain committed to creating an environment where learners are encouraged to grow holistically — academically, emotionally, socially, and creatively.

“Strength does not come from winning. Your struggles develop your strengths.” — Arnold Schwarzenegger

To our teachers and support staff, thank you for the countless hours invested behind the scenes to guide, mentor, and support our learners during this demanding period. Your dedication continues to make a meaningful impact in the lives of our learners every single day.

To our parents and guardians, thank you for your ongoing partnership, encouragement, and support at home. The collaboration between home and school remains one of the greatest contributors to learner success and wellbeing.

Most importantly, to our learners: continue to believe in your abilities, prepare with purpose, and remember that growth often happens through both success and challenge. Every test, performance, competition, and opportunity contributes to the person you are becoming.

As we enter the weeks ahead, we encourage every learner to remain focused, balanced, and confident in their journey.

“Success is the sum of small efforts, repeated day in and day out.” — Robert Collier

Kind regards,
Ms Aishah Kader



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Exam Preparation Focus Series: Managing Exam Stress and Well-being

Learners often focus heavily on revision schedules, study techniques, and academic performance. While these remain important, preparing with purpose also means taking care of mental, emotional, and physical wellbeing. Success during examinations is not determined only by how long a learner studies, but also by how well they manage stress, rest, and balance during demanding periods.

Research in neuroscience and educational psychology consistently shows that chronic stress and exhaustion negatively affect concentration, memory retention, problem-solving abilities, and emotional regulation. When learners become overwhelmed, the brain releases increased levels of cortisol — commonly known as the stress hormone. While small amounts of stress can improve alertness, prolonged stress and sleep deprivation can significantly reduce cognitive performance and increase anxiety levels. Simply put, an exhausted learner cannot perform at their full potential. For this reason, learners will continue to be reminded of the importance of:

- Adequate sleep and proper nutrition
- Maintaining healthy daily routines
- Taking regular breaks during study sessions
- Staying physically active
- Asking for support when feeling overwhelmed

Sleep, in particular, plays a critical role in learning and academic performance. Scientific studies show that during sleep, the brain processes and stores information learned throughout the day. Learners who consistently sacrifice sleep to study often struggle more with concentration, recall, and focus during examinations. Healthy routines also create stability during stressful times. Learners who follow structured schedules, balance study with rest, and maintain consistency often experience lower stress levels and greater confidence when entering the examination room.

As Jim Rohn once said: “Take care of your body. It’s the only place you have to live.”

Equally important is recognising when support is needed. Examination pressure can sometimes feel overwhelming, particularly for teenagers navigating both academic demands and personal growth. Learners must understand that asking for help is not a sign of weakness, but rather a sign of self-awareness and strength. Whether support comes from parents, teachers, friends, or counsellors, no learner should feel that they need to manage stress alone. As Fred Rogers wisely reminded us:

“Anything that’s human is mentionable, and anything that is mentionable can be more manageable.”

At Curro Clayville, we continue to encourage a balanced approach to examination preparation. Hard work and discipline remain essential, but wellbeing matters too. A calm, focused, and emotionally balanced learner will always perform far better than one who is physically exhausted and mentally overwhelmed.

As learners prepare for the weeks ahead, we encourage them to study with intention, rest without guilt, and remember that balance is part of success — not separate from it.



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Mid-Year Examination Processes and Timetable

As the mid-year examinations commence, we would like to outline the key processes and protocols to ensure that learners are well prepared and that examinations run smoothly.

Pre-Examination Briefings

Before each examination, teachers will conduct a short briefing in the classroom. During this time, examination rules and regulations will be read and clarified for learners to ensure a clear understanding of expectations.

Learner Attendance During Exams

Learners who are not scheduled to write on a specific day are allowed to remain at home. However, should a learner attend school on a non-writing day, they will not be permitted to loiter. Instead, they will be allocated to a supervised venue where they are expected to use the time productively for examination preparation. Learners should therefore bring relevant study material with them.

Post-Examination Supervision

Once learners have completed their examination, they are expected to leave the school premises. A 30-minute grace period will be allowed for collection. Learners still on site after this time will be supervised in a designated venue until 14h30, under the supervision of teachers on duty.

Arrival Times

All learners must arrive at school by **07h30** daily. Those writing only in the second session should arrive by **11h00**, with afternoon examination sessions commencing at **13h00**. Learners who arrive earlier than their scheduled session will be provided with a study venue to ensure their time is used productively.

Dismissal Times and Learner Safety

From the **27th of May**, dismissal will take place at **12h00**. For safety reasons, learners are not allowed to wait outside the school premises and must remain on site at all times.

Teachers on Duty will remain on site until 12h30. Thereafter, learners will be allocated to supervised classrooms for study preparation until 14h30. This arrangement applies on days where no afternoon examination session is scheduled.

Should learners need to wait for transport collection, parents are kindly requested to ensure that learners bring along sufficient study material so that they may use this time productively and prepare effectively for upcoming examinations.

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Monday, 01 June 2026	09:00	AFRIKAANS	2 Hours	ENGLISH	2 Hours
Tuesday, 02 June 2026	09:00	MATHEMATICS	2 Hours	HISTORY	2 Hours
Tuesday, 02 June 2026	14:00				
Wednesday, 03 June 2026	09:00	ENGLISH	2 Hours	EMS P1	1 Hour
Thursday, 04 June 2026	09:00	EMS P1	1 Hour	NATURAL SCIENCES	1,5 Hours
	14:00			CHOICE FAL	2 Hours
Friday, 05 June 2026	09:00	LIFE ORIENTATION	1,5 Hours	CREATIVE ARTS	1,5 Hours
Monday, 08 June 2026	09:00	NATURAL SCIENCES	1,5 Hours	MATHEMATICS	2 Hours
Tuesday, 09 June 2026	09:00	GEOGRAPHY	1,5 Hours	AFRIKAANS	2 Hours
	14:00	CHOICE FAL 12:00 - 14:00	2 Hours		
Wednesday, 10 June 2026	09:00	EMS P2	1 Hour	LIFE ORIENTATION	1,5 Hours
	12:30	CODING & ROBOTICS	1 Hour		
Thursday, 11 June 2026	09:00	HISTORY	2 Hours	EMS P2	1 Hour
Friday, 12 June 2026	09:00	CREATIVE ARTS	1,5 Hours	GEOGRAPHY	1,5 Hours
	12:30				
Monday, 15 June 2026	SCHOOL HOLIDAY				
Tuesday, 16 June 2026	YOUTH DAY				
Wednesday, 17 June 2026	09:00				
Thursday, 18 June 2026	09:00			CODING & ROBOTICS	1 Hour
Friday, 19 June 2026	09:00				

Monday, 01 June 2026	09:00	GEOGRAPHY	3 Hours	HISTORY P2	2 Hours	ACCOUNTING P2	2 Hours
Tuesday, 02 June 2026	09:00	CAT P2	2 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P1	2 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P1	2 Hours
Tuesday, 02 June 2026	14:00	AFRIKAANS P2	2,5 Hours	ENGLISH P1 CHOICE FAL P1	2 Hours		
Wednesday, 03 June 2026	09:00	CAT P1	2 Hours	ACCOUNTING P1	2 Hours	ECONOMICS P1	2 Hours
Thursday, 04 June 2026	09:00			MATH P2 MATH LITERACY P2	2 Hours 1,5 Hours	CAT PAT	2 Hours
	14:00	CONSUMER STUDIES	1,5 Hours				
Friday, 05 June 2026	09:00	MATH P2 MATH LITERACY P2	1,5 Hours 1 Hour	CAT PAT	2 Hours	MATH P1 MATH LITERACY P1	3 Hours 2 Hours
Monday, 08 June 2026	09:00	ACCOUNTING	2,5 Hours	LIFE SCIENCES	2,5 Hours	MATH P2 MATH LITERACY P2	3 Hours 2 Hours
Tuesday, 09 June 2026	09:00	BUSINESS STUDIES P1	2 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours		
	14:00					HISTORY P2	3 Hours
Wednesday, 10 June 2026	09:00	PHYSICAL SCIENCES	2 Hours	CAT P2	2,5 Hours		
	12:30						
Thursday, 11 June 2026	09:00	HISTORY	2 Hours	CAT P1	2,5 Hours	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours
Friday, 12 June 2026	09:00	BUSINESS STUDIES P2	2 Hours	ACCOUNTING P2	2 Hours	PHYSICAL SCIENCES P1	3 Hours
	12:30	CHOICE FAL P1	2 Hours				
Monday, 15 June 2026	SCHOOL HOLIDAY						
Tuesday, 16 June 2026	YOUTH DAY						
Wednesday, 17 June 2026	09:00			PHYSICAL SCIENCES P2	1 Hour	PHYSICAL SCIENCES P2	3 Hours
Thursday, 18 June 2026	09:00					ECONOMICS P2	2 Hours
Friday, 19 June 2026	09:00			CONSUMER STUDIES	2,5 Hours	LIFE ORIENTATION 14:00 -16:00	2 Hours
Monday, 22 June 2026	09:00					LIFE SCIENCES	2,5 Hours
Tuesday, 23 June 2026	09:00					ENGLISH P3	3 Hours
Wednesday, 24 June 2026	09:00					AFRIKAANS P3 ISIZULU P3	2,5 Hours
Thursday, 25 June 2026	09:00						
Friday, 26 June 2026	09:00						
GRADE 12 PROVINCIAL SET PAPER		GRADE 12 DISTRICT SET					



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From the Sports Desk: Growth Through Victory and Defeat



As the season draws to a close, our learners continue to represent Curro Clayville with pride, determination, and resilience across both the netball court and soccer field. While sport naturally celebrates victories, it is often in the moments of disappointment and challenge where the greatest growth takes place.

Our netball girls recently faced Glen Austin High School as part of their preparation for the upcoming Intercurro Tournament. The girls displayed excellent teamwork, discipline, and confidence throughout their matches, showcasing both their skill and commitment to continuous improvement. Final scores were as follows:

U14: CCV 11 – 4 Glen Austin High

U15: CCV 14 – 6 Glen Austin High

These results reflect not only talent, but also the countless hours of practice, dedication, and perseverance our girls continue to invest. We are incredibly proud of the way they continue to grow as athletes and ambassadors of the school. The future looks bright as they prepare to showcase their abilities at the upcoming tournament.

This past weekend, our U19 boys travelled to HeronBridge College to compete in the Halala Cup Playoffs. Although the results did not go in our favour, the boys competed with heart, courage, and determination against strong opposition. Results were as follows:

CCV 1 – 4 Meridian Cosmo
CCV 0 – 2 Queens High

Unfortunately, the boys will not progress to the next round of the tournament. However, while the scoreboard may not reflect the outcome we hoped for, it does not diminish the effort, commitment, and resilience they displayed throughout the season. Sport, much like life, is not defined only by victories. Sometimes the greatest lessons come through setbacks, disappointment, and learning how to rise again after defeat. Every challenge becomes an opportunity to reflect, improve, and return stronger. As Michael Jordan once said:

“I’ve failed over and over and over again in my life. And that is why I succeed.”

To our boys: thank you for your hard work, sacrifices, discipline, and for representing Curro Clayville with pride throughout the tournament. You came, you competed, and most importantly, you learned. Growth does not stop after a loss — in many ways, that is where growth truly begins. Another powerful reminder comes from Nelson Mandela:

“The greatest glory in living lies not in never falling, but in rising every time we fall.”



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As a school community, we remain incredibly proud of every learner who steps onto the court or field wearing the Curro Clayville badge. Win or lose, our learners continue to build resilience, teamwork, discipline, and character — qualities that matter far beyond sport itself. Thank you to all parents, staff members, coaches, supporters, and learners for continuing to strengthen and support our growing sports culture. Your encouragement and presence continue to make a meaningful difference.





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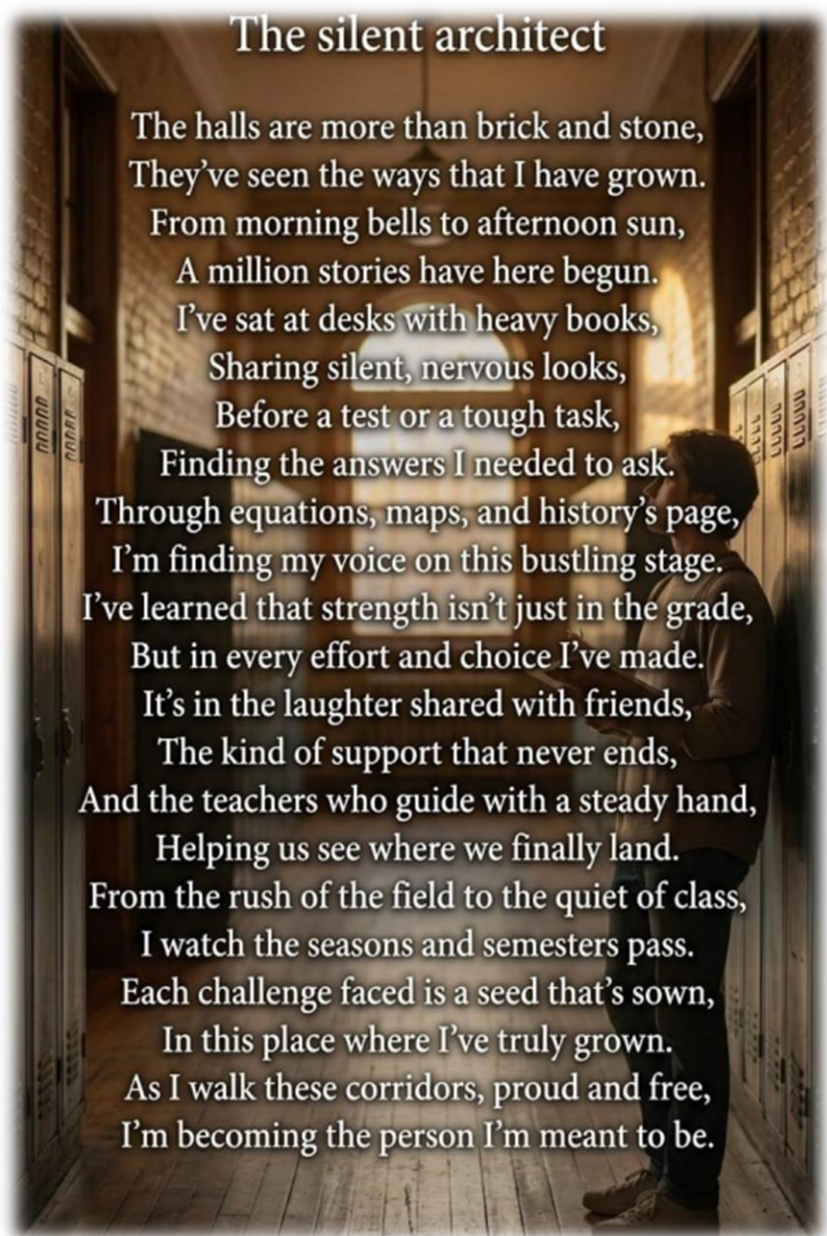
Creative Corner: Creativity Shines Through Curro Create

Curro Clayville learners recently showcased their creativity and talent through their submissions for Curro Create. Learners submitted a wide range of creative pieces including photographs, stories, poems, presentations, and various other artistic works that reflected both originality and passion. The official submission date is on Monday, and then we eagerly await the results from Curro Create.

We are incredibly proud of every learner who participated and commend them for their courage to share their creativity beyond the classroom. Creative platforms such as Curro Create provide learners with the opportunity to express themselves, develop confidence, and refine important skills such as communication, critical thinking, and innovation. Participation in these initiatives also encourages learners to explore their individual talents and passions.

In the coming editions of our newsletter, we look forward to showcasing some of the outstanding learner pieces and celebrating the creativity within our school community.

This week, we proudly feature a poem written by Thendo Mulaudzi in Grade 9 — a top achiever and an active member of our Media, Newsletter, and Innovation Circle. Thendo continues to demonstrate both academic excellence and remarkable creativity, and we are excited to showcase this piece as part of our Curro Create journey.



The silent architect

The halls are more than brick and stone,
They've seen the ways that I have grown.
From morning bells to afternoon sun,
A million stories have here begun.
I've sat at desks with heavy books,
Sharing silent, nervous looks,
Before a test or a tough task,
Finding the answers I needed to ask.
Through equations, maps, and history's page,
I'm finding my voice on this bustling stage.
I've learned that strength isn't just in the grade,
But in every effort and choice I've made.
It's in the laughter shared with friends,
The kind of support that never ends,
And the teachers who guide with a steady hand,
Helping us see where we finally land.
From the rush of the field to the quiet of class,
I watch the seasons and semesters pass.
Each challenge faced is a seed that's sown,
In this place where I've truly grown.
As I walk these corridors, proud and free,
I'm becoming the person I'm meant to be.



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Beyond the Classroom: The Value of Olympiads and Academic Enrichment

This month, Curro Clayville proudly hosted several academic Olympiads, including the CAT, Geography, and History Olympiads. These competitions provided learners with an exciting opportunity to challenge themselves academically, apply their knowledge beyond the classroom, and engage with subjects on a deeper level.

Participating in Olympiads is about far more than simply competing. These academic enrichment opportunities play an important role in reinforcing classroom knowledge, strengthening critical thinking skills, and developing confidence in learners. Research in education consistently shows that learners who participate in extracurricular academic programmes often demonstrate improved problem-solving abilities, stronger independent learning habits, and greater academic engagement overall.

Olympiads encourage learners to think analytically, work under pressure, and apply concepts in unfamiliar contexts — all essential skills for both tertiary education and future careers. In subjects such as Geography and History, learners are challenged to move beyond memorisation and engage critically with information, while the CAT Olympiad strengthens digital literacy, logical thinking, and technological problem-solving skills that are increasingly valuable in the modern world.

As Albert Einstein once said: “Education is not the learning of facts, but the training of the mind to think.”

Participation in these activities also contributes significantly to learner development outside the classroom. Universities and tertiary institutions increasingly look beyond academic marks alone when evaluating applications. Leadership, extracurricular involvement, academic competitions, and enrichment activities all contribute toward building a well-rounded learner profile and a stronger curriculum vitae (CV).

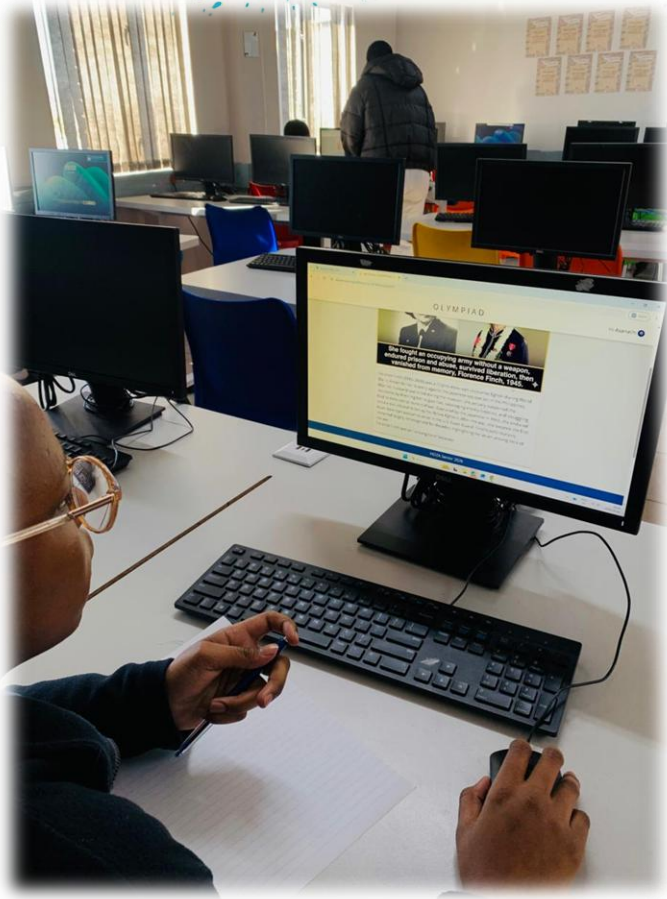
Research from tertiary admission studies worldwide continues to show that learners involved in extracurricular activities often demonstrate stronger time management, leadership, communication, and resilience — qualities highly valued by universities and future employers alike. Academic Olympiads therefore provide learners with a competitive advantage while also helping them discover passions, strengths, and future career interests. Importantly, these opportunities also teach learners valuable lessons about discipline, preparation, perseverance, and personal growth. Whether learners achieve top placements or simply challenge themselves by participating, they gain experience that contributes meaningfully to their development.

At Curro Clayville, we remain committed to creating opportunities that extend learning beyond the traditional classroom environment. We are incredibly proud of every learner who participated in the Olympiads this month and commend them for their willingness to challenge themselves academically.

As Nelson Mandela wisely stated: “Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world.”

We encourage all learners to continue embracing opportunities that allow them to grow, explore their potential, and prepare themselves for success both academically and beyond school walls.

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Study Resources and Past Examination Papers

<https://www.testpapers.co.za/>

<https://www.ecexams.co.za/ExaminationPapers.htm>

<https://wcedportal.co.za/resources-to-support-grade-8-learning-and-teaching>

Teaching Plans: <https://www.education.gov.za/Curriculum/NationalCurriculumStatementsGradesR-12/2023ATPsSP.aspx>

Grade 12 Exam Guidelines: <https://www.education.gov.za/2021Grade12ExamGuidelines.aspx>

Learner Resources: <https://www.education.gov.za/Informationfor/Learners.aspx>

NSC May-June 2025: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1BcG1bKmFGH-tMYxFf4tEZmcFZnO38Ppp?usp=drive_link

In Closing



Grade 12 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 24 June
Grade 11 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 19 June
Grade 10 Mid Year Examination	20 May – 12 June
Grade 8 Mid Year Examination	29 May – 12 June
Grade 9 Mid Year Examination	29 May – 18 June
Grade 11 Leadership Camp	28 - 30 June
Grade 10 Camp	19 – 21 June

Thank you, parents, and guardians.
Your unwavering support, input and constant care is appreciated.



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